SEWING PATTERN · INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

Classic

MEN'S SHIRT

A timeless long-sleeve shirt with a back yoke, collar on a stand, button front, sleeve plackets, two-button cuffs and a curved hem.



SIZES	LEVEL	SEAM ALLOWANCE	FORMATS
35–52 (XS–2XL)	Intermediate	1 cm (3/8 in)	A4 · US Letter · A0

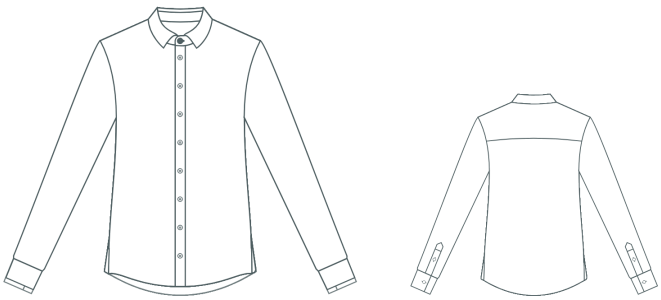
HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES INCLUDED · CLICKABLE LINKS AND QR CODES ON PAGE 8

BenchGoods

WELCOME

Meet the Classic Men's Shirt

This is the shirt every wardrobe needs: a clean, relaxed long-sleeve shirt with a proper collar on a stand, a button front, a back yoke and real shirt details at the sleeves. It is a great project to learn the techniques that make a shirt look professional, and it works for office days and weekends alike.



Design features

- Classic collar sewn onto a collar stand, closed with one button
- Cut-on front plackets: a 3 cm visible placket with 8 buttonholes on the left front, a clean folded facing with buttons on the right front
- Back yoke cut double (outer and inner yoke) for clean, enclosed seams
- Long set-in sleeves with a pointed sleeve placket and two pleats
- Two-button cuffs with angled (mitred) corners
- Curved shirt-tail hem with small side slits
- Relaxed fit through the chest and waist

What is included

- This illustrated instruction booklet
- Printable pattern files in A4, US Letter and A0, one file per size
- Sizes 35 to 52 (chest size in inches, about XS to 2XL)
- Helpful video guides with clickable links and QR codes on page 8

Sizes are chest measurements

The size number is the body chest measurement in inches: size 40 fits a 40 in (101.5 cm) chest. Always check the full size chart on page 4 before you print.

GET READY

Before You Begin

Ten minutes of preparation saves hours of unpicking. Tick each box before you cut.

	Check	What to do
	Print the test square	Print page 1 of your size at 100 % / Actual size. The test square must measure exactly 10 cm (4 in).
	Choose your size	Take your chest, waist and hip measurements and pick the size from the chart on page 4. The shirt has a relaxed fit (about 33 cm / 13 in of ease at the chest), so choose by chest. Between two sizes, take the smaller one for a neater fit, the larger one for a roomy fit.
	Check the length	The pattern is drafted for a height of 180 cm (5 ft 11 in). Compare the center back length and sleeve length (page 4) with a shirt you like. Lengthen or shorten the Back and both Fronts by the same amount between the armhole and the hem, and the Sleeve between the elbow and the lower edge.
	Transfer every marking	Notches, placket lines, button and buttonhole marks, the sleeve slit, the pleat lines and the slit circles on the side seams (page 7).
	Know your allowances	Seam allowance 1 cm (3/8 in) on body pieces, sleeves, yoke and sleeve bindings. 0.7 cm (1/4 in) on the collar, the collar stand and the cuffs, except 1 cm on the stand neck edge and the cuff edge that joins the sleeve. Hem 1 cm. Side slits 1.5 cm.
	Test on a scrap	Fuse a scrap of interfacing, then test your stitch length (2.5 mm), edgestitching and a buttonhole for 7 mm buttons on two layers of fabric + interfacing.
	Plan the tricky parts	The sleeve placket (step 5) and the collar on its stand (step 4) need the most care. Watch the video guides first.

Shirt-making tip

Press every seam as soon as you sew it, and use a slightly shorter stitch (2.2–2.5 mm) for edgestitching and topstitching. A sharp new needle (70/10 or 80/12 Microtex) gives the crisp, straight lines that make a shirt look ready-to-wear.

MEASUREMENTS

Size Charts

Body measurements

Size	35	36	37	38	39	40	42	44	46	48	50	52
Chest cm	89	91.25	94	96.5	99	101.5	106.5	111.75	116.75	122	127	132.25
Chest in	35	35 7/8	37	38	39	40	41 7/8	44	46	48	50	52 1/8
Waist cm	75	77.5	80	82.5	85	87.5	93.25	99.25	104.75	110.5	116.25	121.75
Waist in	29 1/2	30 1/2	31 1/2	32 1/2	33 1/2	34 1/2	36 3/4	39 1/8	41 1/4	43 1/2	45 3/4	47 7/8
Hips cm	87.5	90.25	92.75	95.5	98	100.5	105.5	109.75	114.25	118.75	123.25	128.25
Hips in	34 1/2	35 1/2	36 1/2	37 5/8	38 5/8	39 5/8	41 1/2	43 1/4	45	46 3/4	48 1/2	50 1/2

Height for all sizes: 180 cm (5 ft 11 in).

Size	35	36	37	38	39	40	42	44	46	48	50	52
LETTER	XS	S	S	M	M	M	L	L	XL	XL	2XL	2XL

Letter sizes are a guide only: always choose from your body measurements.

Finished garment measurements

Size	35	36	37	38	39	40	42	44	46	48	50	52
Chest cm	121.9	124.2	127.0	129.5	132.1	134.6	139.7	145.0	150.1	155.4	160.5	165.8
Chest in	48	48 7/8	50	51	52	53	55	57 1/8	59 1/8	61 1/4	63 1/8	65 1/4
Hem width cm	97.5	100.2	102.8	105.5	108.0	110.5	115.5	119.7	124.2	128.8	133.2	138.2
Hem width in	38 3/8	39 1/2	40 1/2	41 1/2	42 1/2	43 1/2	45 1/2	47 1/8	48 7/8	50 3/4	52 1/2	54 3/8
Back length cm	68.4	68.5	68.7	68.8	69.0	69.1	69.2	69.3	69.5	69.6	69.7	69.9
Back length in	26 7/8	27	27	27 1/8	27 1/8	27 1/4	27 1/4	27 1/4	27 3/8	27 3/8	27 3/8	27 1/2
Sleeve length cm	50.9	51.1	50.9	50.9	51.1	51.0	51.1	51.1	51.0	51.0	51.1	51.3
Sleeve length in	20	20 1/8	20	20	20 1/8	20 1/8	20 1/8	20 1/8	20	20 1/8	20 1/8	20 1/4
Cuff length cm	27.7	27.9	28.4	28.7	28.9	29.2	29.7	29.9	30.2	30.7	30.9	31.4
Cuff length in	10 7/8	11	11 1/4	11 1/4	11 3/8	11 1/2	11 3/4	11 3/4	11 7/8	12 1/8	12 1/8	12 3/8
Neckline cm	38.9	39.5	40.2	41.4	42.0	43.1	44.6	46.3	48.0	49.3	51.0	52.7
Neckline in	15 1/4	15 1/2	15 7/8	16 1/4	16 1/2	17	17 5/8	18 1/4	18 7/8	19 3/8	20 1/8	20 3/4

Back length is measured at center back from the yoke-collar seam to the hem. Sleeve length is the sleeve without the cuff; the cuff adds 8 cm (3 1/8 in). Cuff length is the finished cuff, end to end. Neckline is the full neck seam where the collar stand is sewn.

MATERIALS

Fabric & Notions

Suggested fabrics

Light to medium-weight woven fabrics with a crisp or soft hand: cotton poplin, oxford cotton, chambray, cotton twill, linen or linen-cotton blends, fine flannel. Choose a fabric that presses well and holds a fold. Avoid stretch fabrics and very thick or slippery fabrics for a first shirt.

Fabric requirements

Sizes	150 cm (60 in) wide	115 cm (45 in) wide
35 – 39	1.7 m (1 7/8 yd)	2.5 m (2 3/4 yd)
40 – 44	1.8 m (2 yd)	2.5 m (2 3/4 yd)
46 – 48	2.1 m (2 3/8 yd)	2.5 m (2 3/4 yd)
50 – 52	2.3 m (2 5/8 yd)	2.7 m (3 yd)

How calculated: all pieces laid out single layer, grain lines straight, for the largest size of each group, plus about 8 %. Add 10–15 % for checks or stripes that need matching, and for one-way prints.

Notions

- Lightweight fusible interfacing (woven or non-woven for shirts), 90 cm wide: 0.7 m (3/4 yd)
- 13 shirt buttons 7 mm (1/4 in): 8 for the front, 1 for the collar stand, 4 for the cuffs (2 each) + a spare
- 2 small buttons 5 mm (3/16 in) for the sleeve plackets
- Matching all-purpose thread, plus topstitching thread if you like a stronger line (optional)
- Fabric marker or chalk, pins or clips, point turner

The number of buttons is the same for every size.

Printing and assembling

- **A4 / US Letter:** print at 100 %. Each tile is labelled with two numbers, like 1/1, 1/2, 2/1. Tiles with the same first number form one row. Trim one edge, overlap on the dashed border, match the crosses and tape.
- **A0:** send the file to a copy shop and ask for printing at 100 % (actual size).
- Check the 10 cm (4 in) test square before taping everything together.

CUTTING

Pattern Pieces & Cutting

#	Piece	Cut from	Cut
1	Back	Main fabric	1 (whole, single layer)
2	Sleeve	Main fabric	2 (a mirrored pair)
3	Cuff	Main fabric + interfacing	4 + 4
4	Collar Stand	Main fabric + interfacing	2 + 2
5	Collar Stand (extra layer)	Interfacing only	1 (no seam allowance)
6	Collar	Main fabric + interfacing	2 + 2
7	Collar (extra layer)	Interfacing only	1 (no seam allowance)
8	Front Right	Main fabric	1 (right side up)
9	Front Left	Main fabric	1 (right side up)
10	Yoke	Main fabric	2 (outer + inner yoke)
11	Overlap Binding	Main fabric + interfacing	2 + 2 (a mirrored pair)
12	Underlap Binding	Main fabric	2

Cutting tips

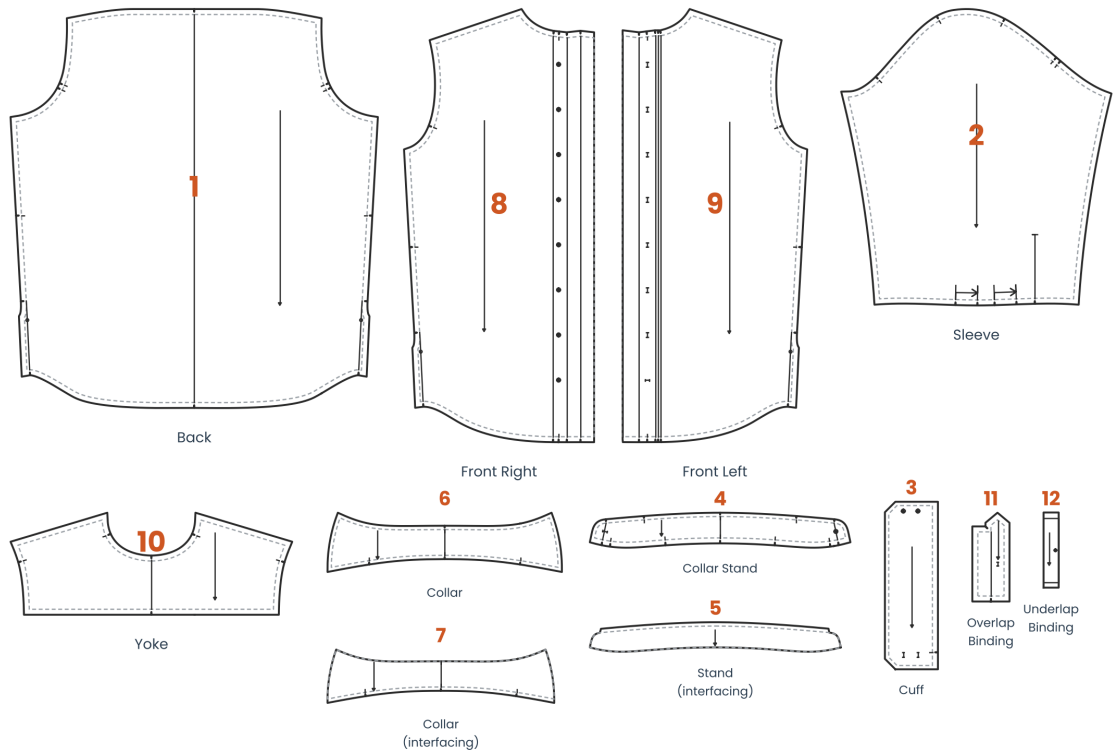
- The Back, Yoke, Collar and Collar Stand are drawn whole, with a center back line in the middle: cut them in a single layer, do not place them on a fold.
- Front Right and Front Left are different pieces (buttons on the right, buttonholes on the left as worn). Cut each one once, right side of the fabric facing up.
- For a mirrored pair (Sleeve, Overlap Binding), cut one, then flip the pattern over for the second; or cut both at once from fabric folded right sides together.
- Keep every grain line arrow parallel to the selvage.
- Interfacing: cut pieces 3, 4, 6 and 11 with their seam allowances, and pieces 5 and 7 exactly to the printed line (no allowance). Pieces 5 and 7 are an extra layer that makes the outer collar and outer stand crisp.

Sewing order at a glance

1. Prepare and interface	2. Front plackets	3. Yoke	4. Collar and stand	5. Sleeve plackets
6. Set the sleeves	7. Side and sleeve seams	8. Pleats and cuffs	9. Side slits and hem	10. Buttonholes and buttons

KNOW YOUR PIECES

Pieces & Markings



All pattern pieces (size 40 shown). Solid line = cutting line, dashed grey line = stitching line.

Mark	What it means
Notches	Small lines on the cutting edge. Match them when you pin. On the sleeve cap and armholes, one notch = front, two notches = back.
Grain line	The long arrow: place it parallel to the selvage.
Center back line	The line in the middle of the Back, Yoke, Collar and Collar Stand. Cut the piece whole; use the line to match centers.
Placket lines	Front Right: 3 lines at 2.5, 5 and 7.5 cm from the edge (fold lines and stitching line of the button facing). Front Left: 4 lines at 3, 6, 6.5 and 7 cm from the edge (fold lines of the visible placket).
Buttons and buttonholes	Dots = buttons (Front Right, collar stand, cuffs, underlap binding). Short "I" lines = buttonholes, drawn in their real direction and length.
Slit circles	The small circle on each side seam of the Back and Fronts marks the top of the side slit.
Sleeve slit and pleats	The single line up from the sleeve lower edge is the placket opening (cut line). The two arrows show the pleats: fold the first line onto the second in the arrow direction.

WATCH AND LEARN

Helpful Video Guides

Scan a QR code with your phone or click the link. Each video shows a technique used in this shirt.

Shirt yoke, burrito method Watch the video Used in Step 3	Collar and collar stand Watch the video Used in Step 4	Tower sleeve placket Watch the video Used in Step 5
Setting in a sleeve Watch the video Used in Step 6	Sewing a shirt cuff Watch the video Used in Step 8	Perfect buttonholes Watch the video Used in Step 10

Good to know

These videos are made by independent creators and may use other patterns. Always follow this guide for the measurements, seam allowances and order of steps.

LET'S SEW

Sewing Instructions

Seam allowance is 1 cm (3/8 in) unless the step says otherwise. Finish raw edges with an overlocker or a zigzag stitch as you go.

1 Prepare and interface

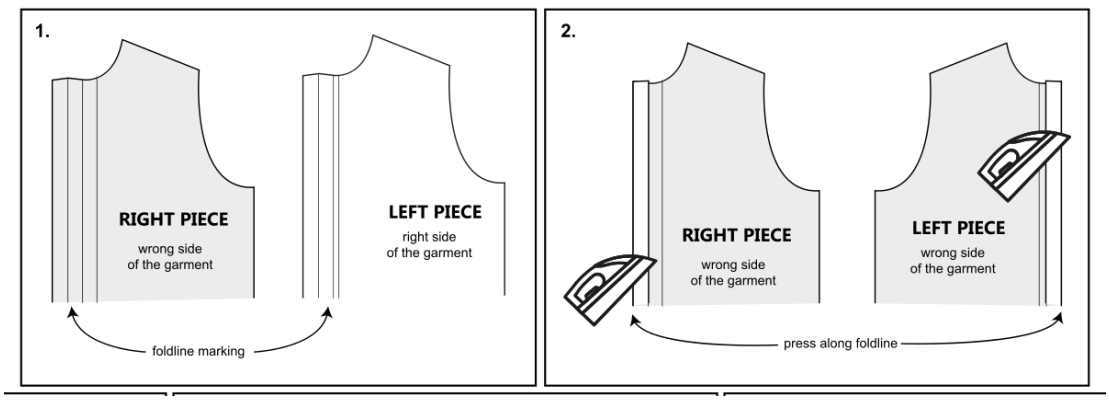
all pieces

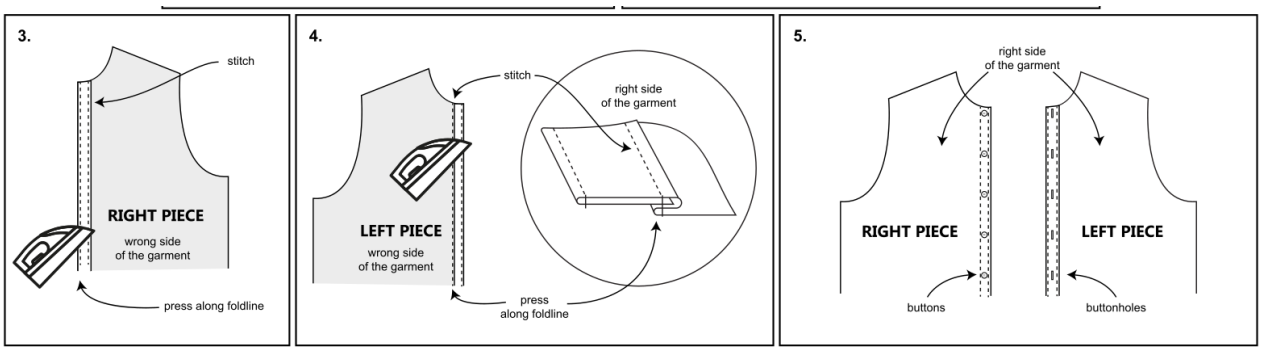
- Fuse interfacing to the wrong side of the 4 Cuffs, the 2 Collar Stands, the 2 Collars and the 2 Overlap Bindings, following the manufacturer's instructions.
- Choose the outer collar and the outer collar stand (the layers that will be seen). On each one, centre the extra interfacing layer (piece 7 on the collar, piece 5 on the stand) inside the seam lines and fuse it on top.
- Transfer all markings: placket lines, buttons and buttonholes, the sleeve slit and pleat lines, the slit circles.
- Staystitch the neckline of the Fronts 0.7 cm from the edge so it does not stretch.

2 Front plackets

Front Right, Front Left · pictures 1–5

- Mark the placket lines: on the wrong side of the Front Right and on the right side of the Front Left (picture 1).
- **Front Right (button side):** fold the edge to the wrong side along the first line, 2.5 cm from the edge, and press (picture 2). Fold again along the second line, 5 cm from the edge, so the raw edge is enclosed; press. Edgestitch close to the inner fold, which lies on the third line (picture 3).
- **Front Left (buttonhole side):** fold the edge to the right side along the first line, 3 cm from the edge, and press (picture 2). Then fold along the second and third lines so the raw edge is tucked inside the placket (see the circle in picture 4). Press and edgestitch close to both long edges of the placket. The finished placket is 3 cm wide, with the center front line in its middle.
- Buttonholes and buttons are made at the very end (step 10, picture 5).





3 Yoke

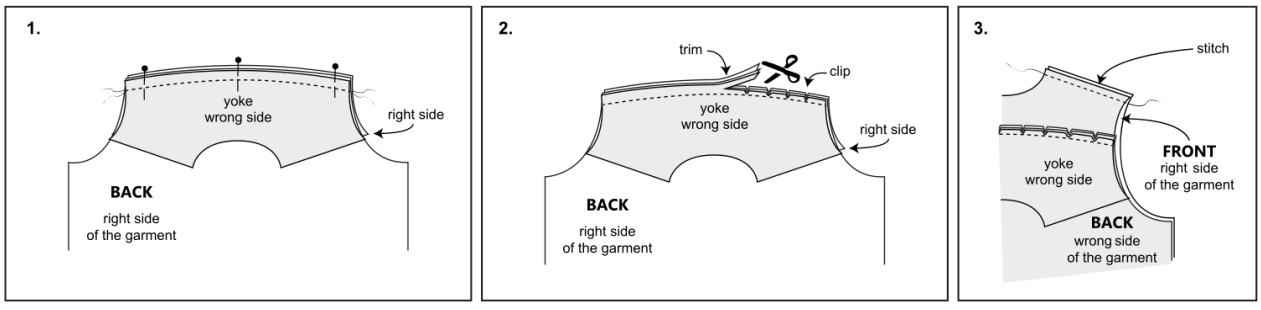
Yoke, Back, Fronts · pictures 1–6

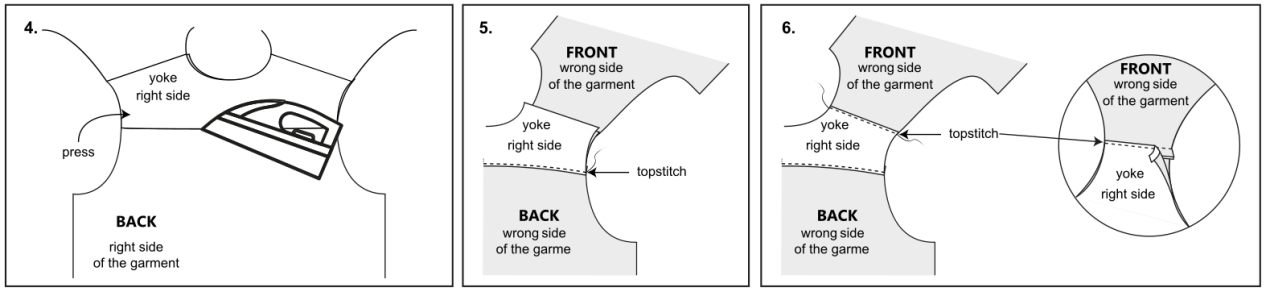
- Place the Back right side up. Put one Yoke (outer yoke) on top, right sides together, and the other Yoke (inner yoke) underneath, right side against the wrong side of the Back, so the Back is sandwiched between the two yokes. Match notches and centers, pin and stitch (picture 1).
- Trim and clip the seam allowances (picture 2). Press both yokes up.
- Pin the shoulder edges of the Front Right and Front Left to the shoulders of the outer yoke, right sides together, matching notches. Stitch (picture 3).
- Press the yokes up (picture 4) and topstitch the back yoke seam close to the edge (picture 5).
- Press the front shoulder seams toward the yoke. Press under the 1 cm allowance on the shoulders of the inner yoke and pin it over the shoulder stitching. Baste the neck and armhole edges of the two yokes together, then edgestitch the inner yoke in place from the right side (picture 6).

Video help: Shirt yoke, burrito method

Burrito option

You can also close the shoulders entirely by machine with the burrito method shown in the video: roll the fronts and back inside the yokes, stitch both shoulders, then pull everything out through the neck.



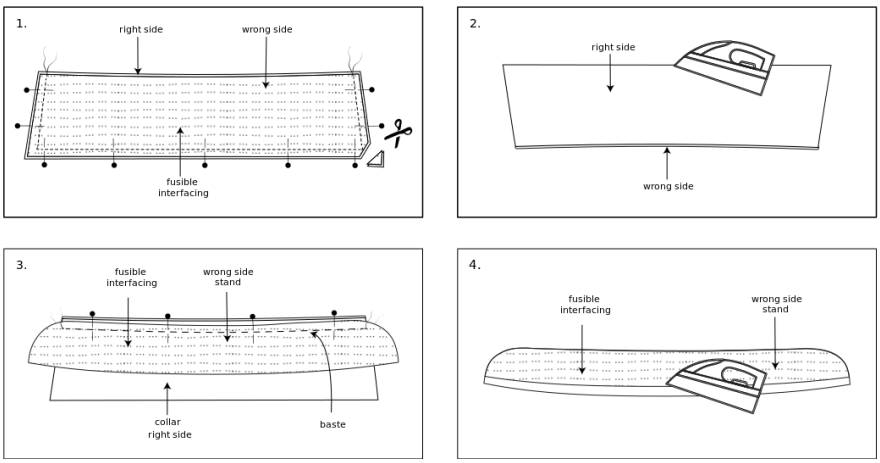


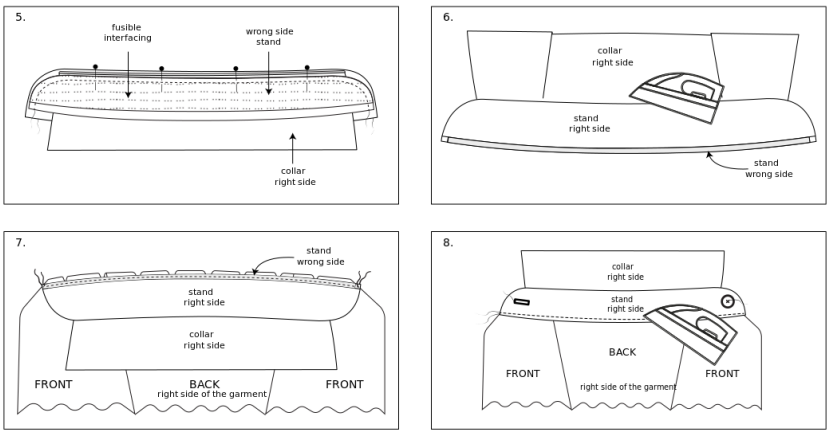
4 Collar and collar stand

Collar 6, Collar Stand 4 · pictures 1–8

- Pin the two Collars right sides together (the outer collar with its extra interfacing on top). Stitch around the outer edge and the two short ends with a 0.7 cm seam, leaving the neck edge open. Trim the corners 2 mm from the stitching (picture 1).
- Turn the collar right side out, push out the points and press. Topstitch the outer edge 5 mm from the edge if you like (picture 2).
- Pin the collar to the outer collar stand, right sides together, matching the center back lines and notches. Baste (picture 3).
- On the inner collar stand, press the 1 cm neck-edge allowance to the wrong side (picture 4).
- Place the inner stand on top, right sides together, so the collar is sandwiched between the two stands. Stitch along the top edge and around the rounded ends with a 0.7 cm seam (picture 5).
- Trim, notch the curves, turn the stand right side out and press neatly (picture 6).
- Pin the neck edge of the outer stand to the neckline, right sides together, matching the center back line and the notches; the ends of the stand meet the front edges of the plackets. Clip the neckline where needed and stitch with a 1 cm seam, keeping the pressed inner stand free (picture 7).
- Press the seam allowances into the stand. Bring the pressed edge of the inner stand over the stitching line, pin and edgestitch all around the stand (picture 8). The stand buttonhole (left end, horizontal) and button (right end) are made in step 10.

Video help: Collar and collar stand





5 Sleeve plackets

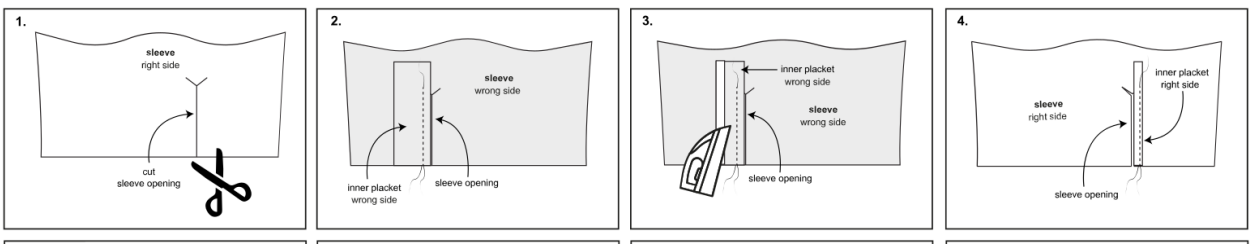
Sleeve, Bindings 11 and 12 · pictures 1–7

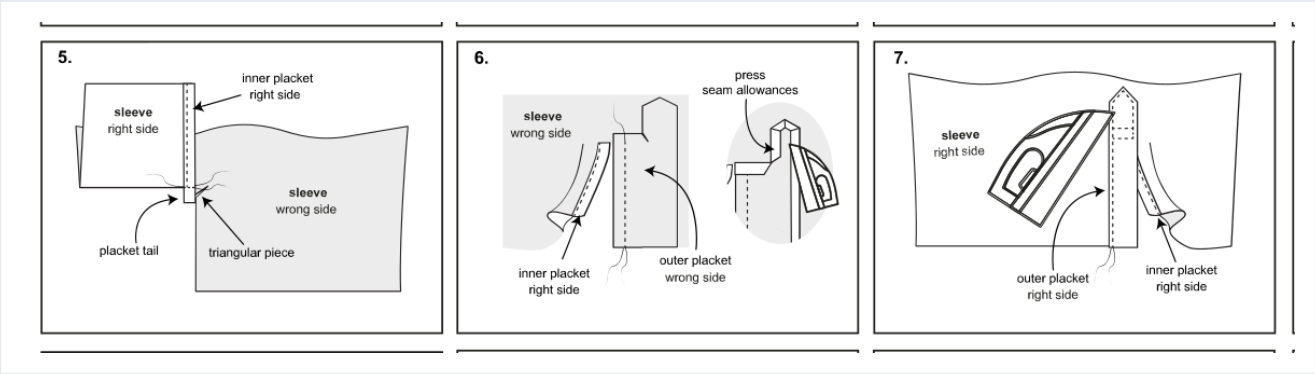
- Work on each Sleeve flat. Cut along the slit line from the lower edge up to its end. At the top, clip 1 cm diagonally into each corner, like a small "Y" (picture 1).
- Underlap Binding (12): pin its right side to the wrong side of the slit edge closest to the sleeve seam (the narrow side). Let the binding extend about 1.2 cm above the top of the slit (the tail) and stitch with a 6 mm seam along the slit edge (picture 2).
- Press under 6 mm on the free long edge (picture 3). Fold the binding over to the right side, so the fold just covers the stitching, and edgestitch (picture 4).
- Fold the sleeve back to show the binding tail and the small triangle at the top of the slit. Stitch across the base of the triangle to hold it (picture 5).
- Overlap Binding (11): pin its right side to the wrong side of the other slit edge (toward the pleats) and stitch with a 1 cm seam. Press under the 1 cm allowances on the free long edge and around the point (picture 6).
- Fold the overlap binding to the right side, covering the stitching and the top of the underlap. Pin, then topstitch along the folded edge, around the point and across the placket above the slit, catching the underlap tail (picture 7). Keep the underlap out of the way while you sew the long edge.

Video help: Tower sleeve placket

Left and right sleeve

Make sure the two sleeves are a mirrored pair before you cut the slits: the slit is on the back half of the sleeve (the side with two notches on the cap).



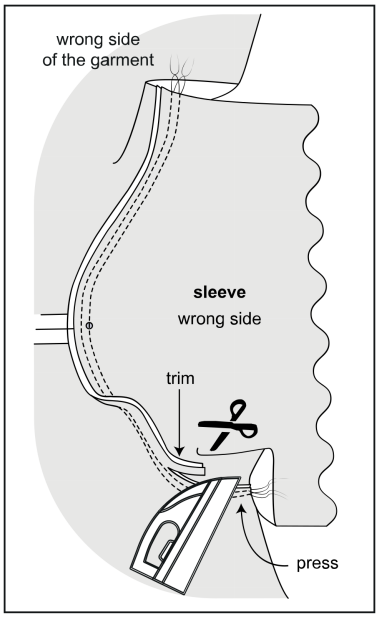


6 Set the sleeves

Sleeves, Body · picture 1

- With right sides together, pin the sleeve cap to the armhole, matching the single notch (front), the double notches (back) and the top notch with the yoke/shoulder seam.
- Stitch with a 1 cm seam, sleeve on top. Stitch again 6 mm inside the seam allowance, then trim and overlock both layers together.
- Press the seam allowances toward the body and topstitch on the body 6 mm from the seam if you want a classic shirt finish.
- Repeat for the second sleeve, checking it goes into the correct armhole.

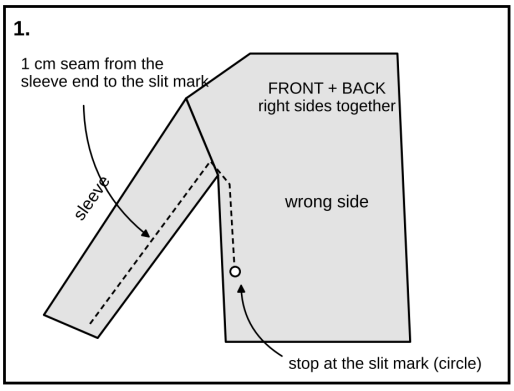
Video help: Setting in a sleeve



7 Side and sleeve seams

Fronts, Back, Sleeves · picture 1

- With right sides together, pin the Front to the Back along the side seam and the sleeve edges together, matching the underarm seams and notches.
- Stitch in one continuous seam from the sleeve lower edge, through the underarm, down to the slit circle on the side seam. Backstitch well at the circle.
- Overlock the two edges together down to about 1.5 cm above the circle. Below that, finish each edge separately: they will become the slit.
- Press the seam toward the back.

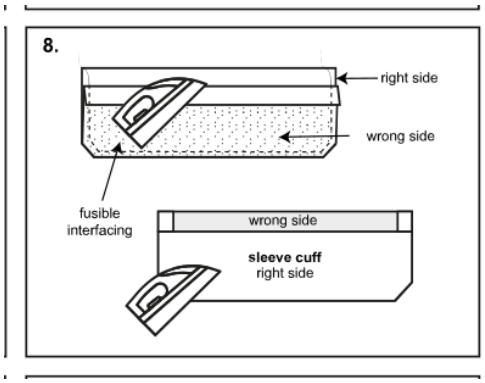


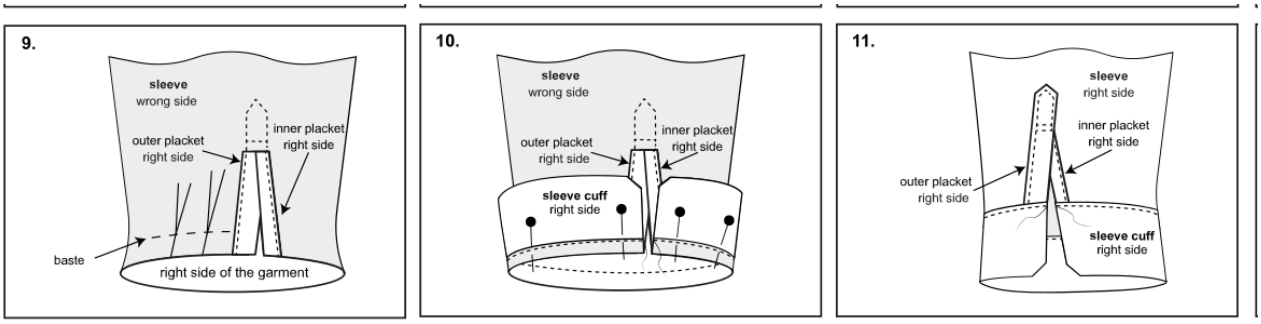
8 Pleats and cuffs

Sleeves, Cuff 3 · pictures 8–11

- Make each cuff from two cuff pieces. On one of them (the inner cuff), press the 1 cm allowance of the long straight edge to the wrong side (picture 8).
- Pin the two cuff pieces right sides together. Stitch the two short ends and the long edge with the angled corners with a 0.7 cm seam, leaving the pressed edge open. Trim the corners, turn right side out and press (picture 8).
- On the sleeve lower edge, fold the two pleats: bring the first pleat line onto the second, in the direction of the arrows (toward the placket). Baste them in place (picture 9).
- Pin the right side of the outer cuff (the unpressed layer) to the wrong side of the sleeve lower edge, with the cuff ends level with the folded edges of the placket. Stitch with a 1 cm seam (picture 10).
- Press the seam into the cuff. Turn the sleeve right side out, bring the pressed edge of the inner cuff over the stitching line, pin and edgestitch all around the cuff (picture 11).

Video help: Sewing a shirt cuff

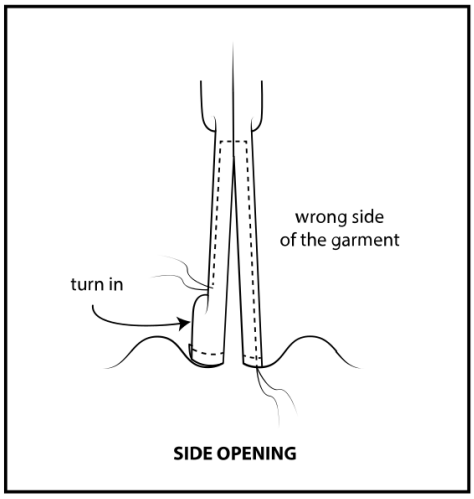


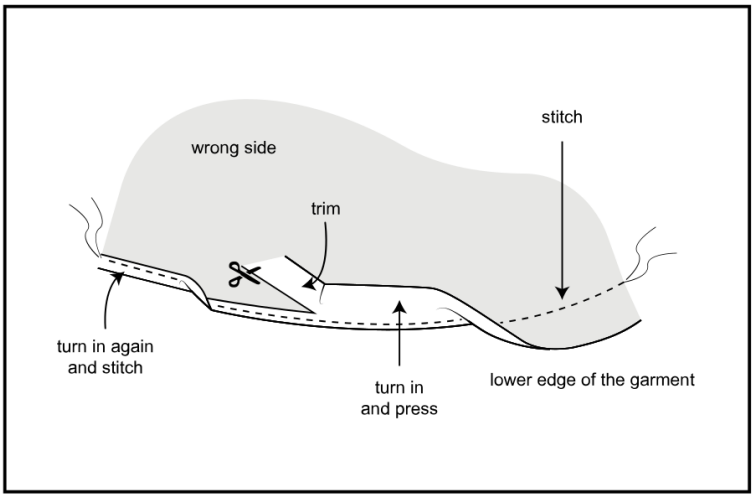


9 Side slits and hem

Fronts, Back · pictures 1–2

- Side slits: on each slit edge, turn the 1.5 cm allowance in twice (about 7 mm, then 7 mm) and press, tapering to nothing just above the slit circle. Stitch the turned edges from the hem up to the circle and pivot across the top of the slit to secure it (picture 1).
- Hem: staystitch 5 mm from the curved lower edge. Turn in along this stitching and press, then turn in again by 5 mm so the raw edge is enclosed (the hem allowance is 1 cm). Ease the curves with the iron, then stitch close to the inner fold (picture 2).
- At the front edges, fold the hem neatly inside the plackets and close the placket ends with a few hand stitches.



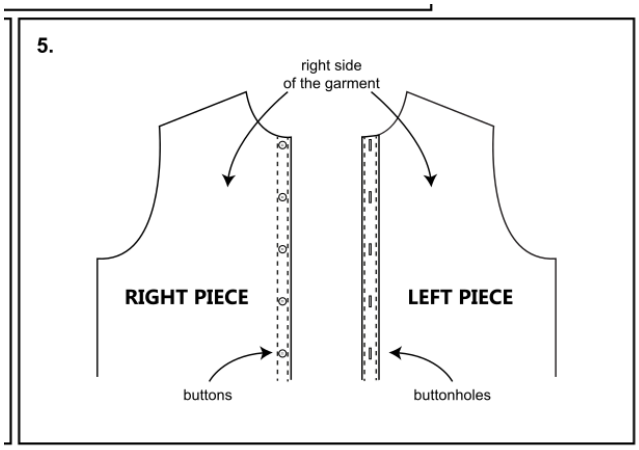


10 Buttonholes and buttons

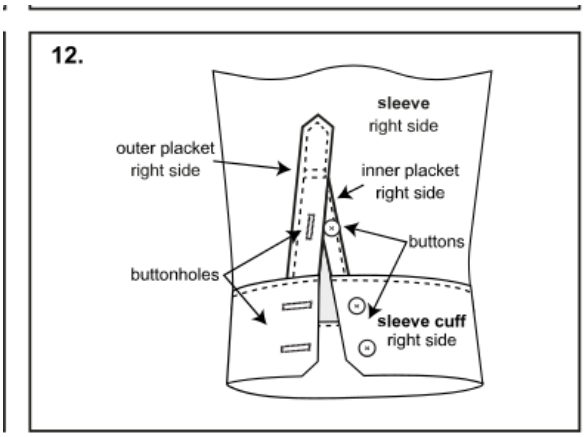
Front Left, collar stand, cuffs, sleeve plackets · pictures 5 and 12

- Front: make 8 buttonholes on the Front Left placket at the marks: vertical buttonholes, except the lowest one, which is horizontal. Sew 8 buttons of 7 mm on the Front Right at the marks (picture 5).
- Collar stand: one horizontal buttonhole on the left end of the stand and one 7 mm button on the right end.
- Cuffs: 2 buttonholes on the overlapping end of each cuff (the end on the overlap binding side) and 2 buttons of 7 mm on the other end (picture 12).
- Sleeve plackets: one small buttonhole in the overlap binding and one 5 mm button on the underlap at the mark.
- Give the whole shirt a final press: collar, cuffs and plackets first, then sleeves and body.

Video help: Perfect buttonholes



Picture 5: buttonholes on the left front, buttons on the right front.



Picture 12: buttonholes and buttons on the cuff and sleeve placket.

ALL DONE

Enjoy Your Shirt



Styling ideas

- In poplin or oxford cotton with chinos and loafers for the office
- In linen, sleeves rolled up and worn open over a T-shirt for summer
- In flannel or chambray as an easy weekend overshirt

Care

Wash according to your fabric, inside out, with buttons done up. Iron while slightly damp: collar first, then cuffs, plackets, yoke, sleeves and body.

Need help?
If a step is unclear, message us through our Etsy shop BenchGoods – we are happy to help.

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